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ERASMUS MUNDUS JOINT MASTERS

APPLICATION Guidebook

Embarking on an academic journey with Erasmus Mundus is a thrilling opportunity, opening doors to world-class education, diverse cultures, and enriching experiences. This is a comprehensive guide to Erasmus Mundus: Application Process and Tips, serves as your compass through this intricate process.

Erasmus Mundus Association
PAKISTAN
www.facebook.com/groups/EMAPakistan





CAN I APPLY FOR ERASMUS MUNDUS ?



Erasmus Mundus programmes offer a unique chance to broaden your horizons, experience different cultures, and enrich your academic and personal life in ways you cannot even imagine. The basic criterion to apply is having a relevant bachelor's degree. While an impressive CGPA and a "perfect" profile can give you an edge, but it is not just about academic achievements; it is about a holistic view of your potential. Don't underestimate the power of a compelling motivation letter and strong recommendations. They can often outweigh a less-than-perfect CGPA.

Remember, every journey starts with a single step. Don't be discouraged by doubts. Instead, use them as fuel to work harder, improve your skills, and demonstrate your potential. Sometimes, it is the underdogs who surprise everyone and emerge victorious. Believe in yourself, be authentic in your application, and let your passion shine through. You never know - your determination might just be what sets you apart and lands you that future building opportunity you have been dreaming of.

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Introduction



1 What is Erasmus?

The Erasmus programme, named after Dutch scholar **Desiderius Erasmus Roterodamus**, is the longest-running student exchange initiative in the world, established in 1987 and funded by the European Commission. Its mission is to enhance the educational, professional, and personal growth of individuals in Europe and worldwide. Erasmus primarily facilitates short-term student exchanges within European countries, promoting collaboration among European universities. The programme supports lifelong learning, aiming to foster sustainable growth, quality jobs, social cohesion, innovation, European identity, and active citizenship.

The word "Erasmus" also served as the acronym for: "**E**u**R**opean Community **A**ction **S**cheme for the **M**obility of **U**niversity **S**tudents."

2 What is Erasmus Mundus?

In contrast, Erasmus Mundus is a broader, international initiative that offers joint master's degree programmes, along with scholarships, to students and scholars from both European and non-European countries. Erasmus Mundus programmes are full-degree programmes, allowing students to earn their entire master's degrees through international collaborations between universities. While Erasmus focuses on European exchanges, Erasmus Mundus provides a global platform for higher education and cultural exchange.

- High-level integrated study programmes of excellence
- Featuring study periods in different countries
- Resulting in joint or multiple degrees upon completion

What is EMJM?

Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters (EMJM, previously called EMJMD) are high-level integrated study programmes at master level funded by European Union under Erasmus+ scheme. These programmes are designed and delivered by an international partnership of higher education institutions from different countries worldwide.

EMJMs are programmes of excellence and should contribute to the integration and internationalisation of the European Higher Education Area (EHEA). The specificity of EMJMs lies in the high degree of jointness/integration among the participating institutions, as well as the excellence of their academic content.

Scholarships are available for students to take part in these programmes. The masters programmes themselves offer these scholarships to the best-ranked applicants worldwide, in annual application rounds. The scholarships cover the cost of a student's participation in the programme, travel, and a living allowance.

What about Ph.D. ?



Can I apply through Erasmus Mundus for Ph.D. studies?

No, the joint degree programmes are exclusively for master's degrees.

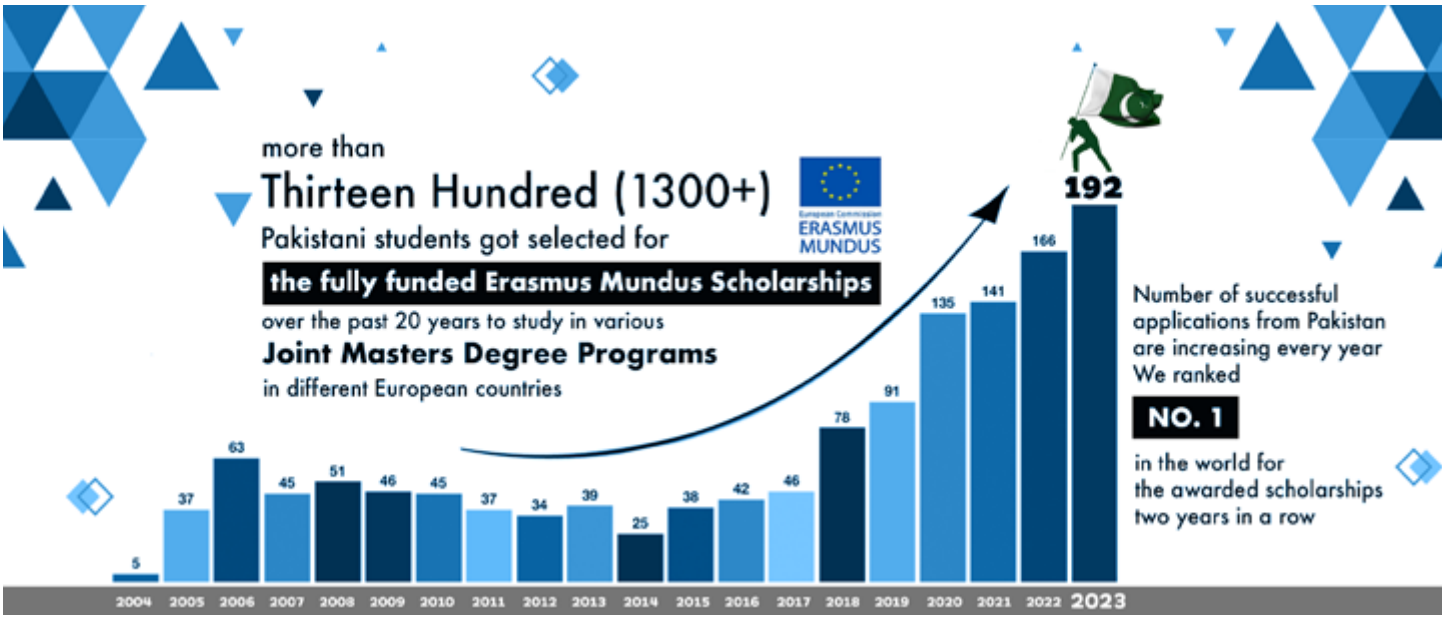
Doctoral programmes and fellowships are available through the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions. For additional details, please visit: https://marie-sklodowska-curie-actions.ec.europa.eu

You can join the following Facebook groups for more information and guidance:

Erasmus Mundus Association PAKISTAN
www.facebook.com/groups/EMAPakistan

Scholarship Network
www.facebook.com/groups/scholarships.pk

THE OPPORTUNITY FOR PAKISTANI STUDENTS



Pakistani students continue to make the nation proud by clinching a significant number of Erasmus Mundus Scholarships every year. Their success story is a testament to the extraordinary potential that lies within the youth of Pakistan. It is crucial for aspiring students to realize that these achievements are not confined to a selected few renowned universities; rather, they showcase the boundless opportunities available to every Pakistani student, regardless of their university's repute.

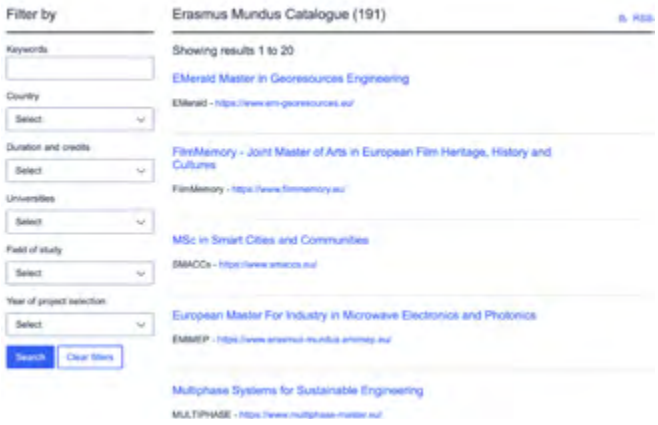
If you are a student aspiring for an Erasmus Mundus Scholarship, remember, your determination, hard work, and passion matter the most. Believe in yourself and your capabilities. These scholarships are not just recognition of academic excellence but also of your resilience and tenacity. No matter if you are from a big city or a small town, a renowned university or otherwise, you have a chance. So, dream big, aim high, and know that no hurdle is too high to overcome. Your journey toward global success starts with believing in your own potential. Go out there and prove that Pakistani talent knows no bounds!

Where to start?

LETS FIRST UNDERSTAND SOME BASICS

When considering Erasmus Mundus, remember it is not a single programme; rather, it comprises numerous master's programmes, each funded individually with its own set of rules and regulations. Take your time to browse through the catalogue and choose programmes that align best with your goals and aspirations. For all students the starting point should always be the catalogue:

www.eacea.ec.europa.eu/scholarships/erasmus-mundus-catalogue_en



To understand how the catalogue operates, let's begin by examining the life cycle of the programmes. Annually, under Erasmus+ funding, the EACEA initiates a call inviting universities to seek funding for launching Erasmus Mundus master's programmes. Universities collaborate in consortia, submitting proposals for evaluation. After a rigorous assessment, selected programmes secure funding for up to six-year period, enabling them to admit four student batches. These programmes are then added to the Erasmus Mundus catalogue. Subsequently, each individual programme initiates its admission call, allowing students to apply for enrolment and scholarships. For example, if a programme secures funding in 2023 and commences its first batch in 2024, it can subsequently admit three more batches in 2025, 2026, and 2027.

After the completion of a programme's funding period, consortia have the option to reapply for new funding by submitting a new proposal. However, they are required to undergo the evaluation process again, with no guarantee of selection solely based on their prior funding status. This means the catalogue evolves yearly, as some programmes wrap up their funding, new ones are introduced, and certain programmes secure renewed funding.

As a student, it is crucial not to delay applying for a programme for too long, as there's always the possibility that your preferred programme might not be available in the following year.

HOW TO APPLY?

SIX SIMPLE STEPS TO APPLICATION

Erasmus Mundus is not a single programme but a collection of numerous EMJM programmes. Each programme is administered by a distinct consortium of universities, each having its unique requirements and selection criteria. Programme durations may vary, spanning from one to two academic years (equivalent to 60, 90, or 120 ECTS credits).

1. EXPLORE CATALOGUE



Review the list of EMJM programmes in the catalogue and choose the programmes that best align with your interests and goals.

2. GATHER INFORMATION



Visit the websites of the selected programmes, thoroughly read all the details, understand the requirements, and assess the scope of each programme.

3. PREPARE APPLICATION



Gather all the necessary documents, update your CV, draft your motivation and reference letters, and obtain the required language certification.

4. DOCUMENTS REVIEW



Have your documents reviewed, seek advice and feedback from alumni and experts, and work on improving your application accordingly.

5. APPLICATION SUBMISSION

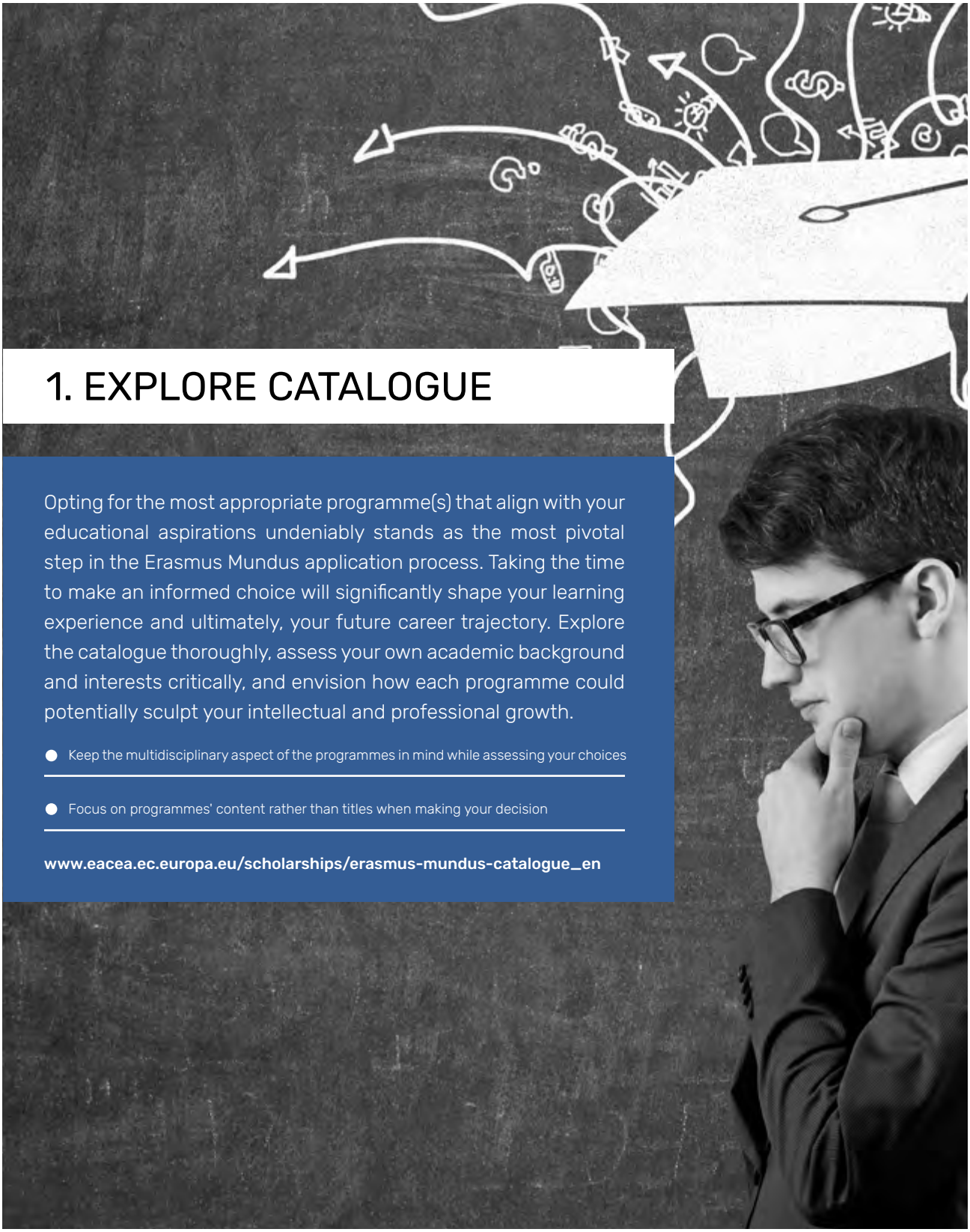


Follow the specific programme's instructions on their website meticulously. Fill out the required forms and upload the necessary documents as per their guidelines.

6. INTERVIEW AND RESULTS



Regularly check your emails, stay updated with any announcements, prepare thoroughly for potential interviews, keep positive thoughts and pray for good luck.



1. EXPLORE CATALOGUE

Opting for the most appropriate programme(s) that align with your educational aspirations undeniably stands as the most pivotal step in the Erasmus Mundus application process. Taking the time to make an informed choice will significantly shape your learning experience and ultimately, your future career trajectory. Explore the catalogue thoroughly, assess your own academic background and interests critically, and envision how each programme could potentially sculpt your intellectual and professional growth.

- Keep the multidisciplinary aspect of the programmes in mind while assessing your choices
- Focus on programmes' content rather than titles when making your decision

www.eacea.ec.europa.eu/scholarships/erasmus-mundus-catalogue_en

PROGRAMME SELECTION

Erasmus Mundus differs significantly from other scholarship opportunities in that it doesn't function as an external component added to existing university programmes. Instead, it offers integrated joint degree programmes specifically designed and tailored by international consortia of universities emphasizing collaboration between institutions, interdisciplinary approaches, and a shared curriculum, providing students with a holistic educational experience rather than simply attaching a scholarship to pre-existing courses.

As an applicant, it is imperative to shift your mindset when exploring Erasmus Mundus programmes. Instead of limiting yourself to a narrow academic focus, embrace the wealth of your past education and experiences across diverse disciplines. Identify a specific area within your field that genuinely excites you, and then explore how this passion can harmonize with other disciplines to tackle multifaceted challenges. By blending your expertise with a broader spectrum of knowledge, you pave the way for innovative solutions to intricate real-world problems, aligning perfectly with Erasmus Mundus's ethos of interdisciplinary learning.

TITLES ARE DECEPTIVE

Programme names are not the whole story. Resist the temptation to judge a programme solely by its title. Explore the specifics; you might discover a rich interdisciplinary world concealed beneath seemingly narrow labels.

Lets look at a couple of examples:

1. Erasmus Mundus master of Science in Public Sector Innovation and eGovernance (PIONEER):
This programme is an exemplary demonstration of interdisciplinary nature. Tailored for students with diverse backgrounds in public administration, information systems, engineering, social sciences, law, and more, it delves into the crossroads of governance, technology, and public service innovation. Participants dissect the digital transformation in government, evaluating the impact of eGovernance on citizen engagement. Through this exploration, students acquire profound insights into the global reshaping of public sectors through technology. This programme exemplifies Erasmus Mundus' commitment to offering a rich, interdisciplinary educational experience beyond the programme's title.

2. Islands and Sustainability (ISLANDS):
This is another prime example of interdisciplinary nature with a focus on environmental sustainability. This programme attracts students from diverse academic backgrounds such as geography, urban/regional planning, environmental science/engineering, economics, tourism, political science or related fields. Through a blend of ecological studies, community engagement, and policy analysis, students gain a holistic understanding of island ecosystems and the socio-economic factors influencing their sustainability. This programme not only showcases Erasmus Mundus' commitment to interdisciplinary learning but also highlights its dedication to addressing pressing global issues through comprehensive education and research.

Application Limit



Can I simultaneously apply to more than one programme?

Yes, you can apply to multiple Erasmus Mundus Joint Master Degree programmes simultaneously. Unlike in the past when there was a limit of three programmes per year, there is no longer any restriction. Feel free to apply to as many programmes as align with your interests and academic goals.

UNDERSTAND CONSORTIUM DYNAMICS

Choosing the right Erasmus Mundus programme involves more than just understanding its curriculum; it is about grasping the intricate dynamics of the consortium behind it. Each Erasmus Mundus programme operates within a consortium of universities, where each institution contributes its distinctive expertise and research capabilities. This collective strength greatly shapes the educational experience you will receive.

As a prospective student, your decision-making process should transcend the programme's surface content and you should explore deep into the universities within the consortium. If your ambitions lean towards pursuing a Ph.D. after your master's, examining the research opportunities offered by these universities becomes indispensable. Investigate their ongoing projects, renowned faculty, and collaborations. These factors can profoundly influence your academic journey, especially if you aspire to engage in advanced research.

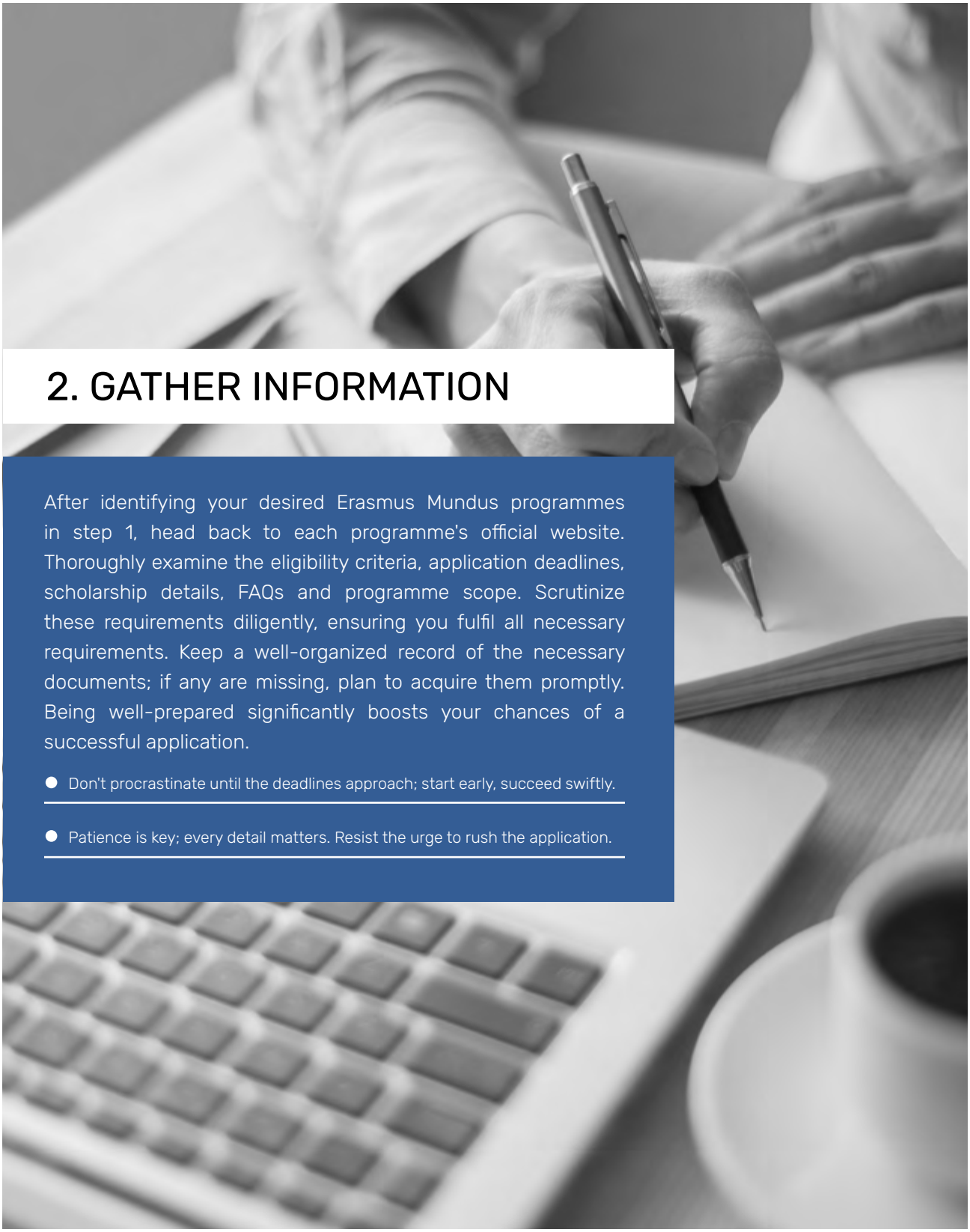
Conversely, if your primary objective is immediate employment post-master's, focus on the countries where you plan to study. Each country offers a unique professional landscape, employment opportunities, and industry connections. Understanding the employment prospects specific to each location can significantly impact your career trajectory.

Moreover, as you craft your motivation letter, it is not just about showcasing your passion for the subject matter. It is equally vital to spotlight your profound understanding of the consortium universities. Your motivation letter should reflect your awareness of their distinct research initiatives, the expertise of their faculty members, and the overall campus culture. By demonstrating this knowledge, you not only exhibit genuine interest but also underline your suitability for the programme. Admissions committees are keen to see applicants who have done their homework and understand how their aspirations align with the consortium's academic environment.

QUALITY OVER QUANTITY

Even though you can apply to as many programmes as you want, it is crucial to prioritize quality over quantity. Rather than applying to numerous programmes without much thought, focus on the ones that truly resonate with your passions. Investing your time and effort into one or two programmes that deeply connect with you is far more rewarding than spreading yourself thin. Select the programme(s) that align perfectly with your goals and give your best effort in your application. Remember, dedicating yourself to what you love often yields the best outcomes.

Relying on others' suggestions blindly is a risky move. Keep in mind that everyone has their unique priorities and interests, which may not align with yours. It is common to see students sharing lists of programmes they believe are all there is for a particular field, but how can you be sure they have conducted a thorough investigation? Your future is at stake, and you can't afford to entrust it to others. Take charge of your academic journey and ensure that the choices you make are well-informed and in line with your aspirations. Take your time and properly explore the catalogue.



2. GATHER INFORMATION

After identifying your desired Erasmus Mundus programmes in step 1, head back to each programme's official website. Thoroughly examine the eligibility criteria, application deadlines, scholarship details, FAQs and programme scope. Scrutinize these requirements diligently, ensuring you fulfil all necessary requirements. Keep a well-organized record of the necessary documents; if any are missing, plan to acquire them promptly. Being well-prepared significantly boosts your chances of a successful application.

- Don't procrastinate until the deadlines approach; start early, succeed swiftly.
- Patience is key; every detail matters. Resist the urge to rush the application.

UNDERSTAND REQUIREMENTS

Every Erasmus Mundus programme operates through its own dedicated website. Explore these websites thoroughly to understand each programme's eligibility criteria, application deadlines, and the availability of scholarships. Scrutinize each detail meticulously to confirm that you possess the necessary qualifications and meet all requirements. Carefully review the checklist of required documents for your chosen programme. Ensure you have all the necessary documents, including language proficiency certificates. Initiate this process well in advance, recognizing that acquiring some documents can be a time-consuming task.

BASIC PREREQUISITE

To qualify for an Erasmus Mundus programme, you must have finished your first higher education degree, typically comprising 180-240 ECTS credits, equivalent to 3-4 years of bachelor's studies in Pakistan.

FINAL YEAR STUDENT

If you are in your final year of undergraduate studies, you may still be eligible for certain programmes, but you will be admitted on a conditional basis and will need to submit your final degree and transcript later. It is essential to carefully read the specific programme details to understand the eligibility criteria for each programme you are interested in applying.

ALREADY HOLDS A MASTER'S

If you already possess a master's degree, you can still apply if you have a valid justification for pursuing a second master's. However, keep in mind that individual programmes may have specific requirements or preferences for applicants with prior master's degrees. Therefore, it is wise to review the official programme website or reach out to the course coordinator for clarification.

What is ECTS?

FAQ

Do I have to convert my Pakistani credits to ECTS?

ECTS (European Credit Transfer and Accumulation System) is the standard method used by European higher education institutions to measure academic credits. As a Pakistani student, you don't need to convert your credits to ECTS. Instead, you can follow the basic rule of thumb: one full year of study, as per Pakistani standards, is considered equivalent to 60 ECTS credits. This simplifies the process, making it easier for Pakistani students to understand their eligibility for Erasmus Mundus programmes.

CGPA CRITERIA

Erasmus Mundus programmes do not have a universal CGPA requirement; instead, each programme establishes its own specific admission criteria, which may include a minimum CGPA among other requisites. However, CGPA is just one aspect considered and not the sole determinant for selection. Your overall profile, comprising work experience, online courses, extracurricular activities, publications, volunteer work and other accomplishments, is thoroughly evaluated during the selection process.

If you have a low CGPA, you can compensate that by showcasing your strengths in other areas. The Erasmus Mundus programmes value a well-rounded candidate, so it is essential for you to present a comprehensive view of your skills, achievements, and experiences in the application. This holistic approach allows you to demonstrate your suitability for the programme beyond just academic performance.

LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY

You must demonstrate your language proficiency in the primary language of instruction, which is mostly English. Commonly accepted language tests include IELTS and TOEFL, though specific tests and score requirements vary across programmes. To meet the language criteria, you should carefully review the guidelines of your preferred programmes. Some programmes might have additional language prerequisites for specific countries based on different study tracks; carefully review each programme's criteria before choosing the right study track. In some cases, programmes may accept previous degrees taught in English from specific countries sufficient as a language proficiency proof, however, only few includes Pakistan in the list of countries. If such an option is clearly mentioned, you can provide a certificate from your previous university to verify your prior English-medium education.

PROGRAMME VS. PARTNER COUNTRY

Applicants for Erasmus Mundus programmes have the choice to apply as either programme country students or partner country students. If you are a Pakistani national, you are typically categorized as a partner country applicant, unless you meet the criteria of the 12-month rule. According to this rule, if you have spent more than twelve months within the last five years studying, training, or working in one or more programme countries, you should apply as a programme country candidate. The 5-year reference period is calculated backward from the EMJM scholarship application deadline. It is crucial to understand the distinction between programme and partner country categories because applying in the wrong category can lead to rejection. Programmes may require a "Residence Certificate" to confirm your residency status in a specific country.

The selection process for Erasmus Mundus programmes is intricate since programmes aim to pick the best candidates while ensuring geographic diversity. There is a guideline that no more than 10% of the total scholarships a programme can grant over the four batches can be awarded to students from the same country. However, there are exceptions to this rule based on extra funding for specific regions. The distribution of scholarships also varies between programme and partner country applicants.

While these rules might seem complex, it is important not to dwell on them excessively. As an applicant, your focus should be on strengthening your application, and it is best to be truthful in your application. Getting too entangled in these intricacies can lead to doubts and weaken your motivation to apply. Instead, channel your energy into maximizing even the smallest chance of acceptance. Give your application your absolute best effort; sometimes, even a 1% chance can lead to success.

For detailed information about the countries categorized as programme countries and partner countries, please visit this link: Erasmus+ Programme Guide - Eligible Countries

Admission Cycle



When do the admissions usually start and what are the deadlines?

The application schedule for Erasmus Mundus programmes varies widely. Some programmes open as early as September for the next fall's intake, while others commence as late as February or March of the same year. Submission deadlines also varies according to the application start date. It is important to understand that you can easily access the schedules of various programmes by visiting their respective websites. Avoid wasting time asking others about such basic details. Stay informed by consistently monitoring the programmes' official websites and their social media channels for updates related to the application process.

AGE LIMITATION

There is typically no specific age limitation for Erasmus Mundus programmes, allowing candidates of various ages to apply. However, if you have a significant study gap since your last degree, it is crucial to address it strategically in your application. Be honest, explaining the reasons for the break, and highlight any relevant work experience, practical exposure, or other education initiatives undertaken during this period. Emphasize extracurricular activities, volunteer work, or community service that demonstrate your skills and personal growth. Strong letters of recommendation and a well-crafted motivation letter can further strengthen your application by showcasing the value you bring to the programme despite your age or study gap.

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

Erasmus Mundus programmes are committed to promoting inclusivity and providing equal opportunities for all applicants, including those with disabilities and special needs. You have to meet the general selection criteria, no preference or quotas are allocated. However, if selected with or without scholarship, extra funding support for specific needs might be available for eligible candidates. This support can be utilized for acquiring special items or services, such as assistance from third parties, adapting work environments, or covering additional travel and transportation expenses.

It is highly recommended for applicants to directly contact the Erasmus Mundus programmes they are interested in applying to. Programme coordinators and university representatives can provide detailed information about the available support, services, and any specific initiatives aimed at assisting disabled students during their studies. Additionally, applicants can inquire about accessibility features in university facilities and housing options to ensure a comfortable and inclusive learning environment.

FUNDING AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Erasmus Mundus programmes provide students with much more than a transformative educational experience. They also empower students to achieve their goals by offering generous scholarships. These scholarships are highly prestigious in Europe, with numerous benefits aimed at ensuring a smooth and enriching academic journey. In the past, the distribution of scholarship had a different structure, including a monthly amount of 1,000 Euros, separate yearly travel allowance and a one-time installation payment. However, all programmes selected from 2021 onwards adhere to the new simplified structure. The following information is based on the updated scheme and here's what the scholarship covers:

1. Monthly Allowance: You will receive a monthly stipend of 1,400 (fourteen hundred) Euros to assist with essential expenses. This allowance covers your daily needs, travel, visa, and installation expenses. The duration of this financial support can last up to 48 months or depending on the length of your study programme, providing stability throughout your studies.

2. Full Tuition Fee Waiver: The Erasmus Mundus programmes can incur significant tuition fees, reaching up to 18,000 Euros for a two-year master's programme, posing a substantial financial challenge. However, a major benefit of the Erasmus Mundus scholarship is the complete exemption from tuition fees. This means you are freed from the financial burden of educational costs, enabling you to concentrate fully on your academic pursuits and personal development.

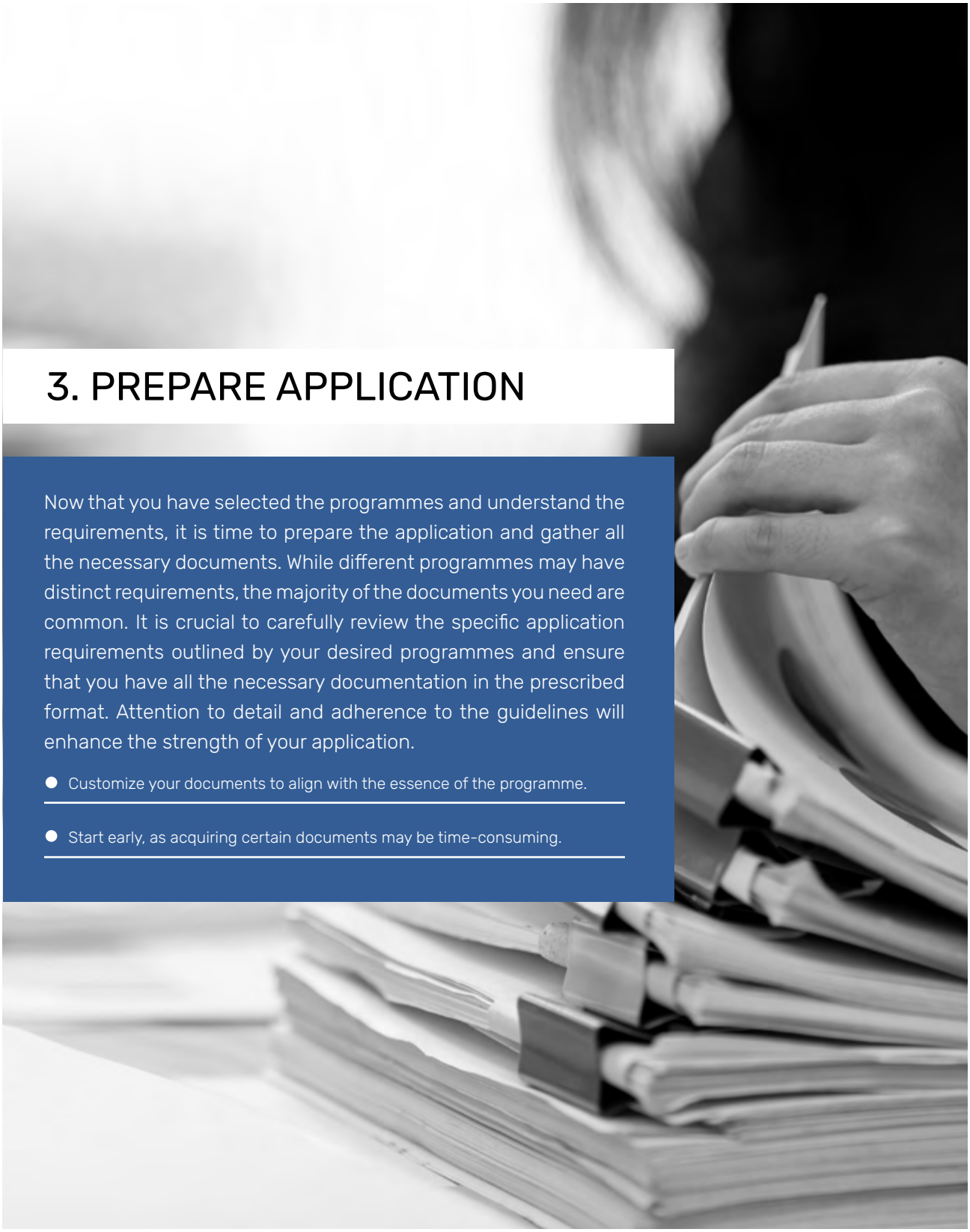
3. Comprehensive Health and Travel Insurance: The scholarship also includes health insurance coverage aligned with the stringent requirements set by the EACEA. This ensures that you have access to quality healthcare, providing peace of mind as you navigate your academic pursuits. The extensive insurance coverage should extend to potential damage or loss of luggage during travel, third-party liability, accidents, and unfortunate events leading to death. The programme is also responsible to provide the same insurance even if you are joining as a self-funded student.

A CRUCIAL FINANCIAL NOTE

While the scholarship is comprehensive, it is important to note that you still need some initial funds. The first monthly payment is received only after arriving in your first study country and only after opening a European bank account. Consequently, you must arrange funds for your visa application, airfare to Europe, initial accommodation booking, and some money for your first few weeks' expenses. This all could easily amount to two to three thousand (2000-3000) Euros, which, given the weaker Pakistani currency, can pose a substantial burden.

Do not be disheartened by these additional expenses because the 1400 Euros monthly scholarship includes more than what you typically need for monthly sustenance. This extra amount is meant to cover additional costs like travel, although it is distributed in small monthly instalments. You can easily save more than 600 Euros per month, depending on the city you reside in, allowing you to accumulate enough to repay any loans from friends or family that were taken to cover the initial costs. However, remember that Erasmus Mundus is a mobility programme, and you need to save money from your monthly stipend to cover mobility and visa costs for traveling between countries during different study periods. It is crucial to create a proper budget and plan future expenses carefully.

Before you start your actual application, it is vital to have a complete understanding of all the requirements. The most effective way to achieve this is by thoroughly exploring the websites of the programmes you are interested in. Read through each web-page carefully, check for FAQs, and seek out any available programme guides. If you have any uncertainties and confusions, programme coordinators are your best resource for clarification. However, remember to be considerate and avoid bombarding them with unnecessary emails. Instead, review all the information first and then send a single, well-crafted email that includes all your queries in a concise and focused manner.



3. PREPARE APPLICATION

Now that you have selected the programmes and understand the requirements, it is time to prepare the application and gather all the necessary documents. While different programmes may have distinct requirements, the majority of the documents you need are common. It is crucial to carefully review the specific application requirements outlined by your desired programmes and ensure that you have all the necessary documentation in the prescribed format. Attention to detail and adherence to the guidelines will enhance the strength of your application.

- Customize your documents to align with the essence of the programme.
- Start early, as acquiring certain documents may be time-consuming.

DOCUMENTS CHECKLIST

Getting ready for a successful application is about collecting the right documents. As each programme has its own requirements, it is vital to make a checklist that matches the requirements of the programme you are applying to. This checklist helps ensure you submit all the required documents, covering things like academic records, language skills, motivation letter, recommendation letters, and any extra materials the programme asks for. Starting early and going through each item on the checklist will make your application journey smooth and successful.

Following are the most essential and common documents that most programmes may ask for:

1 DEGREE CERTIFICATES

At the time of submitting the online application, you need to upload scanned copies of your certified degree or degrees (if you already have a master's). In this context, it is important not to confuse the term "certified," as it simply means issued by a recognized authority, which, for a degree, refers to a university. Therefore, when you see the term "certified degree" that only means the original degree issued by your university with all the necessary stamps and signatures.

If you have completed your studies but are still awaiting the issuance of the degree, you can upload a certificate issued by your university confirming that the degree will be issued at a later date. If you are still in the final year of your studies and waiting for results, the university should also state that, based on your previous records, you will successfully complete the programme. This certificate is also known as a Hope Certificate. Ensure that any such certificate is signed and stamped by the university and includes a date of issue. However, it is important to note that applying on the basis of a Hope Certificate means that if an Erasmus Mundus programme considers you for admission and/or scholarship, they will only offer it on a conditional basis. You must provide the final degree within the set deadline to finalize your admission and to secure the scholarship; failing to do so will automatically void the conditional offer.

If you possess an unconventional degree, like a two-year bachelor's followed by a two-year master's degree from Pakistan, which is mostly not internationally recognized, you need to obtain an equivalence certificate from HEC before applying. Visit the HEC website for detailed information. In case you have any confusion about recognition of your degree, reach out to the programme coordinators for clarification.

Attestation/Legalisation



Do I need to submit legalised and/ or attested documents at the time of application submission?

When submitting the online application, typically, you only need to provide copies of certified documents (original documents issued by the university or other authorities). After selection and for visa purposes, all documents must undergo the proper legalization process.

Since Pakistan is now part of the Hague Apostille Convention, you must follow the Apostille procedures as outlined by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs. For details, visit

https://apostille.mofa.gov.pk

Carefully review the instructions on the MOFA website to fully understand the requirements and procedures for applying for an Apostille. For certain documents, such as university degrees, additional steps are required before Apostille application. For instance, you must first obtain HEC attestation before proceeding with the Apostille process.

2 OFFICIAL TRANSCRIPTS

In addition to the degree, students must submit the transcript of records, commonly known as the marks sheet in Pakistan. Typically, the mark sheets also include details of the grading system at the back. If this information is not available, you may also need to submit a letter from the university detailing the credit system information, but only if the programme specifically requires it. Final year students should submit all transcripts up to their latest semester along with the Hope certificate, as mentioned in previous section.

3 LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY CERTIFICATE

Proficiency in English is a key requirement for all Erasmus Mundus programmes. The specific definition of proficiency varies depending on the criteria set by each programme. Generally, one of the recommended language certificates, most commonly IELTS, is considered sufficient. Applicants should carefully follow the programme guidelines, which outline specific score requirements for overall proficiency and in each language module for different language certificates.

Some programmes also accept previous education in English as a satisfactory proof. If this is explicitly stated on the programme's website, applicants can submit a letter from their university certifying that the medium of instruction for their previous degree was English. Sometimes the university certificate for language proficiency might only be accepted from English-speaking countries, and Pakistan is not considered one. Therefore, thoroughly reviewing the instructions on the programme's website is critical to avoid any misunderstandings that could lead to disqualification of your application.

If you are applying to a programme that offers study tracks in languages other than English, you may be required to submit language certificates for those specific languages as well. It is important to be careful when selecting study tracks, ensuring they are available in English unless you are proficient in the additional language(s) required.

If you find yourself behind schedule for the language test, and there is a concern about receiving the results or certificate after the application deadline, it is advisable to reach out to the programme coordinators promptly. Inquire whether it is possible to submit your application with just the proof of test registration and the commitment to provide the results at a later date. Some programmes may have flexibility and could offer additional time to accommodate such situations. Communication is key in such cases, and coordinating with the programme officials can often lead to a solution that ensures your application is considered despite the timing challenges.

Avoid waiting until the last minute to take the language test. Start preparing well in advance to achieve a good score. Even if you have an excellent academic record, a high language score is crucial. Some students may assume that meeting the minimum language score requirement is sufficient when they have a strong academic profile. However, in reality, it could be the key factor that sets two candidates apart. Beginning your preparation early provides you with enough time to improve your language skills and secure a competitive score, thus increasing your chances of a successful application.

4 CURRICULUM VITAE

A carefully prepared CV not only boosts the quality of your application but also grabs the attention of the admission committee. Since each programme receives hundreds of applications, a well-crafted CV is very important for making your application stand out. It serves as a key document that compels the admission committee to pay proper attention to your application and other supporting materials. Without a well-presented CV, your academic achievements might go unnoticed.

A CV primarily showcases past academic and professional achievements, but it also serves as a platform for applicants to emphasize their skills and unique qualities. The format, language, and presentation offer a distinct opportunity for creativity, enabling applicants to leave an impactful first impression on the reader. While Erasmus Mundus programmes mostly recommend using the Europass format for the CV, providing a user-friendly way for students to create professional-looking CVs, however, when it comes to the language and presentation aspects, students makes lots of common mistakes, diminishing the effectiveness of their CVs.

It is crucial to effectively structure the flow of information in your CV. The order of details should reflect their relevance and importance. For instance, when applying for further education, your previous educational achievements should be listed before any work experience because relevant education holds greater weight as a criterion, even if you have several years of experience. On the other hand, when applying for a job, emphasizing your professional experience is more important so that can be listed first. Additionally, maintaining a chronological order within each section is advisable. For instance, if you have multiple degrees, list the latest one at the top, similarly, when listing multiple job experiences, start with the latest job.

The length of the CV is also an important consideration. For master's applicants, it is optimal for the CV not to exceed two pages. Incorporating irrelevant details can detract from its quality. The following two pages are a sample CV of a fictional person, provided for your reference. Pay attention to the information flow and review the tips provided in the right margin.

Sheikh Chilli

Nationality: Pakistani **Email address:** sheikh@chilli.com

ABOUT ME

A dreamer eager to engage with fellow dreamers to exchange fantastical ideas and contribute to the realm of imaginative knowledge. Aspiring to enhance my expertise in nonsensical studies through collaborative learning and cross-cultural experiences. Seeking admission to the "Erasmus Mundus Masters in Enchanted Realms: The Magic of Cross-Cultural Whimsy" to further explore my whimsical perspectives.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Master of Whimsical Studies

University of Daydreams and Fantasies, Wonderland [08/2019 – 09/2021]

Website: www.daydreams.edu
Field(s) of study: Whimsical Philosophy
Final grade: 3.4/4.0
Thesis: Exploring the Boundaries of Imagination: A Journey into Absurd Realities

Key Modules:

- Dreamy Creativity
- Theoretical Nonsense Studies

Bachelor of Absurdity

Institute of Nonsensical Studies, Follyland [08/2013 – 09/2017]

Field(s) of study: Unconventional Wisdom
Final grade: 3.8/4.0

Key Modules:

- Nonsensical Narratives
- Surrealistic Storytelling
- Dream Logic and Fantasy Realms

Honours: Crowned the "Master of Nonsense" for outstanding contributions to whimsical knowledge

WORK EXPERIENCE

Chief Daydreamer

Chilli's Imaginary Enterprises, Dreamland [01/2023 – Current]

- Led a team of imaginative minds, fostering brainstorming sessions to develop fantastical ideas.
- Pioneered innovative projects in the realm of absurdity, successfully bringing numerous dreams to life.
- Organized yearly "Absurdity Conventions" to showcase ground breaking nonsense, gaining positive acclaim for embracing the magic of the absurd.

Fantastical Visions Intern

Kingdom of Dreams and Laughter, Follyland [01/2023 – Current]

- Orchestrated grand parades of nonsensical characters and fantasies, enhancing the kingdom's dreamlike atmosphere.
- Collaborated with imaginary creatures to create a whimsical environment.
- Achieved recognition by receiving the "Dreamweaver Award" for exceptional contributions to fantastical visions.

Personal Information:
Adding unnecessary personal information to your CV is not recommended. The essential items, especially in the context of Erasmus Mundus, are your nationality and email address. You may also include your LinkedIn profile. All other details, such as date of birth, gender, address, CNIC number, passport number, etc., are entirely unnecessary unless a programme explicitly requests additional information for inclusion in the CV.

Summary Section:
Depending on the purpose of your CV, you may include a professional summary or objective, or about me section. Keep it concise, with 2-3 sentences that are clear and to the point.

Education:
As previously mentioned, when applying for further studies, your prior education holds the utmost importance. The determination of eligibility heavily relies on your educational background. Therefore, it is illogical to allocate an entire page to work experience only to place education elsewhere on the following page.

Ensure that all relevant details about each degree are prominently displayed in one place. It is a common mistakes to merely list the degree title without providing additional details or scattering relevant projects or thesis information relevant to your degree across other sections. Keep all information about each degree in one place. There's no need to include unnecessary details, such as the campus address; simply listing the city and country is sufficient.

If you have multiple degrees, list them in chronological order, with your most recent degree appearing first.

Work Experience:
When listing your work experience, ensure clarity and impact:
- Make the title of your job the most prominent piece of information. This allows the reader to immediately understand your position and level of responsibility.
- Directly below your job title, list the name of the company or organization where you worked, followed by the dates of your employment.
- Summarize your key responsibilities, achievements, and contributions in bullet points. Aim for 3-4 concise points that effectively highlight your role without overwhelming the reader.
- Craft each point to highlight your actions and contributions, focusing on the skills you applied to accomplish tasks and the positive impact they had on the project or company as a whole.
- Focus on the most relevant aspects of your experience that align with programme you are applying for.

ONLINE COURSES AND CERTIFICATES

Certificate in Gibberish Communication (Dreamland Academy)
[2023]

Acquired proficiency in the art of whimsical communication, mastering the language of absurdity to convey fantastical ideas effectively.

Fantastical Leadership (Whimsy Institute)
[2022]

Developed visionary leadership skills in the realm of absurdity, learning to guide creative thinkers and turn imaginative dreams into whimsical realities.

PUBLICATIONS

The Art of Absurdity: Navigating Nonsensical Realms
[2021]

Journal of Imaginary Studies

This work explores the intricate artistry of absurdity, providing insights into navigating whimsical dimensions and venturing through the surreal landscapes of imagination.

Dreamlike Creativity: Unravelling the Secrets of Whimsy
[2018]

Conference on Fantastical Innovations

A comprehensive exploration of the dynamics of dreamlike creativity, this publication unravels the secrets behind bringing whimsical ideas to life.

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Mother tongue(s): **Gibberish**

Other language(s):
Nonsense
LISTENING B1 **READING** B2 **WRITING** B1
SPOKEN PRODUCTION C1 **SPOKEN INTERACTION** C1

Levels: A1 and A2: Basic user; B1 and B2: Independent user; C1 and C2: Proficient user

EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Founder of the Society for Whimsical Explorations
[2021]

Organized Whimsy Workshops for Aspiring Dreamers
[2020]

Participated in the Annual Nonsensical Olympics
[2020]

HONOURS AND AWARDS

Most Creative Dreamer
University of Daydreams and Fantasies [2021]

Dreamweaver Award
Kingdom of Dreams and Laughter [2020]

Certificates and Courses:
If you have various certificates and have completed many online courses, it is essential to include only those that are relevant to the programme you are applying for. Adding irrelevant courses will unnecessarily lengthen your CV and diminish the impact of the relevant sections However, if you have only a couple of certificates or courses, you can list them all, and relevance becomes less of a concern.

For each certificate or course, list the title along with the issuing authority in parentheses, followed by the year of completion. A brief description, consisting of a couple of lines, should be added to highlight the key skills or knowledge you gained from the course.

Publications:
If you have publications, they can significantly enhance your application. Keep in mind that publications refer to research papers published in conferences or journals, not articles or blogs on websites.

Once again, it is crucial to format each publication properly. The most important details to include are the title of the publication, the year it was published, the publication where it appeared, and a brief description of the content. There is no need to list all the authors; if you are including it in your CV, it is understood that you are one of the contributors, so mentioning that is redundant.

If any of your publications are currently under review or pending publication, you can still include them in your CV. Be sure to indicate their status in brackets after the title.

Language Skills:
The key focus in this section is your English proficiency, which should be determined by your scores in IELTS or any other recognized language test. If you don't have a language certificate yet, you can self-assess your level. However, it is important to understand the different proficiency levels; you should not self-assess as a C2, a level that even some native speakers cannot claim. Be realistic and truthful.

Additionally, if you have skills in other languages, you can include them, depending on their relevance to the programme.

Other Sections:
For other sections, such as extracurricular activities, honours, and awards, adhere to basic writing guidelines: include what, where, and when, without adding unnecessary details. Consider the relevance to the programme when deciding whether to include each item in your CV.

5 MOTIVATION LETTER

The motivation letter is a vital element of your application, offering a unique chance to present your story, ambitions, and suitability for the programme. Unlike a CV, it allows you to explain why you are pursuing the programme and how it aligns with your goals.

WHY THE MOTIVATION LETTER MATTERS

Admissions committees rely heavily on the motivation letter to differentiate between candidates with similar academic and professional backgrounds. It provides insight into your personality, your passion for the field, and your long-term goals. The motivation letter can be the deciding factor in your application, making it essential to approach this letter thoughtfully.

WHAT TO INCLUDE IN YOUR MOTIVATION LETTER

1. Personal Motivation: Describe what initially sparked your interest in pursuing your chosen field of study. Motivation is all about showing how your past actions have shaped your current path and how your aspirations are driving your future goals. Share personal experiences, academic pursuits, or professional ambitions that have inspired you to seek deeper knowledge in this area.

2. Interest in the Program: Clearly articulate why you are interested in a particular master's programme. Research the programme thoroughly and mention specific aspects that appeal to you, such as the curriculum, faculty, research opportunities, or unique features that set the programme apart from others. Show that you have a deep understanding of what the programme offers and how it aligns with your academic and career objectives.

3. Connection to Future Goals: Discuss how a master's programme will help you achieve your future goals. Whether you aim to advance in your current career, or pursue further academic research, explain how a particular programme will provide you with the skills, knowledge, and experiences necessary to reach your aspirations. Be specific about the competencies you hope to gain and how they will be applied in your future endeavours.

4. Differentiating Yourself: Use the motivation letter to set yourself apart from other candidates. Highlight any unique experiences, perspectives, or qualities you bring to the table that make you an ideal fit for the programme. This could include specific academic achievements, relevant work experience, or extracurricular activities that demonstrate your commitment and suitability for the field.

A motivation letter is not your CV in words. The person reviewing your application already has your CV in hand, so repeating the same details is a missed opportunity. Instead, use the motivation letter to provide context and depth to your experiences, highlighting your personal motivations, aspirations, and the reasons why you are passionate about the programme. This is your chance to tell your story, not to restate your qualifications.

TIPS FOR WRITING AN EFFECTIVE MOTIVATION LETTER

Engage the Reader: Capture the reader's attention right from the beginning with an interesting and personal opening. Avoid overused quotes, which often feel impersonal. Instead, consider sharing a personal anecdote or a statement that genuinely reflects your passion for the field.

Avoid Rehashing Your CV: Use your motivation letter to offer new insights, not repeat what is already in your CV. Focus on the motivations behind your choices and explain how your experiences have shaped your goals and led you to apply for this particular programme.

Be Authentic: Be honest and true to your personal story. Express your genuine interest and enthusiasm for the field rather than writing what you think the admissions committee wants to hear. Authenticity resonates with readers and makes your letter more memorable.

Highlight Key Experiences: Focus on the most relevant experiences and achievements that have prepared you for this programme. Explain how they contribute to your skills and how they align with the programme's requirements and goals.

Provide Specific Examples: Avoid vague or general statements. Back up your claims with concrete examples. Specific details add depth to your letter and make it more credible.

Maintain a Clear Structure: Organize your letter logically, with a clear introduction, body, and conclusion. A well-structured letter keeps the reader engaged and ensures your message is easy to follow, making a strong impact.

Keep It Concise: Be focused and avoid unnecessary details. Admissions committees often have limited time, so a precise letter will always be more effective than one cluttered with irrelevant information. Every sentence should serve a clear purpose. Writing concisely is an art—while it is easy to fill pages with content, the real skill lies in conveying the same message in just a few impactful lines.

Demonstrate Strong Writing Skills: A well-crafted letter showcases your ability to communicate effectively and serves as an additional demonstration of your language proficiency. Pay attention to grammar, punctuation, and clarity, ensuring it is error-free and professional.

Seek Constructive Feedback: Before finalizing your motivation letter, have someone with experience—such as a mentor, professor, or peer—review it. Often, we are in our own bubble and assume the reader knows certain details or context. An independent reviewer can offer valuable suggestions, point out any gaps in clarity or coherence, and highlight areas where your message may not come across as intended. This fresh perspective can greatly improve the overall impact of your letter.

Plagiarism and AI



How to check for Plagiarism?

If you are writing your letter yourself, there is no reason to worry about plagiarism. Only those who know they have copied content from others worry about such things. Instead of relying on plagiarism checkers, focus on creating original content and stop copying.

What about AI tools, can we use them?

You can certainly use AI tools to your advantage. They can help with grammar checks, spelling corrections, or even provide general feedback to help you refine your ideas. However, keep in mind that you are not the only one using these tools, and much of the AI-generated content tends to look similar. If you want your letter to stand out, it is essential to write it yourself, using your own ideas, tone, and unique voice. No AI tool can replicate your personal story or the authenticity that comes from writing in your own style.

To sum up, the motivation letter is a reflection of your actions and past decisions, not a fictional work. It should naturally convey how your academic choices, extracurricular activities, and experiences align with the programme you are applying for. Motivation doesn't develop overnight, and a sudden shift in your field without relevant steps can seem unconvincing. If you are transitioning to a new field, your letter should include concrete actions you have taken, like relevant courses or internships, to prove your commitment. By crafting a coherent narrative, you present a compelling story that highlights your strengths and clearly demonstrates your passion and fit for the program, which is the key to a successful application.

6 RECOMMENDATION LETTERS

Recommendation letters are another crucial part of your application, offering external validation of your qualifications, character, and potential. Professors, supervisors, or mentors provide insight into your academic abilities, work ethic, and personal attributes. Strong recommendations can reinforce the qualities you have highlighted in your application and support your candidacy.

Common Challenges

In Pakistan, students often face the issue of professors being too busy to write recommendations, sometimes asking students to draft the letters themselves. While this is not ideal, if asked to do so, make sure your draft is honest and balanced, avoiding exaggeration. Include specific examples that your professor can endorse, and always give them the opportunity to review and modify the letter.

Another common challenge is that some professors may refuse to provide a recommendation. This often happens when students have not built strong relationships during their studies. Securing good recommendations begins from the first day of your undergraduate studies, not after graduation. Cultivate a positive relationship with your professors through active participation and academic dedication. Professors are more likely to write supportive recommendations for students who have consistently shown engagement and promise.

How Many Recommendations Are Required?

The number of recommendations required depends on the programme you are applying for. Most programmes typically ask for two recommendations, but some may require three and there are few that requires none. Be sure to carefully check each programme's requirements to ensure you meet their expectations.

Programmes also have different submission processes for recommendation letters. Some may ask you to upload the recommendation along with your application, while others require the recommender to submit the letter directly based on instructions sent via email. Be mindful of each programme's specific process and communicate these requirements clearly to your recommender.

From Whole Should You Get Recommendations?

It is generally recommended to have academic recommendations, especially from professors who have taught you relevant subjects. However, some programmes may allow or even encourage you to include a professional recommendation if you have relevant work experience. In that case, you can submit one letter from a professor and one from a supervisor at your workplace.

When selecting recommender, ensure that they know you well and can provide meaningful examples of your skills and achievements. If you are including a professional recommendation, make sure the supervisor can speak to your work ethic, problem-solving skills, and how your academic background has influenced your professional contributions.

7 PROOF OF NATIONALITY

To prove your nationality, you must attach a copy of your valid passport, as it is a mandatory requirement for most Erasmus Mundus programmes. If you currently don't have a passport, it is important to start the application process as soon as possible. Passport processing times can vary, taking anywhere from several days to weeks, and any delay could result in missing application deadlines. Be proactive to ensure you have your passport ready in time to submit a complete application.

8 RESIDENCE CERTIFICATE

A Residence Certificate is an essential document for most Erasmus Mundus programmes, as it determines whether you should apply as a "Programme Country" or "Partner Country" candidate. The category under which you apply directly impacts your eligibility for specific scholarships and travel contributions. For more details on how this classification affects your application, see the section "Programme vs. Partner Country" on page 14.

What Documents Can Be Used as Proof of Residence?
In most cases, a Residence Certificate issued by your local municipality is sufficient to prove your current place of residence. However, some programmes may require additional documents. Typically accepted documents include:

- Official Residence Certificate from any local government body (like Union Council).
- A letter from your employer, university, or training institution confirming your current place of residence.
- Utility bills (e.g., electricity or water bills), if in your name.

It is crucial to ensure the document is recent (issued within the last 12 months) and includes your full name, exact address, and the issuance date.

It is also important to note that a domicile certificate is not considered a valid Residence Certificate. While a domicile confirms legal residency in a particular region, it does not verify your current physical address. Similarly, documents such as your passport and CNIC cannot be used as proof of residence. Also, don't get confused by PRADO-listed documents for proving residence as mentioned on some of the programmes' websites, which apply primarily to European students. Pakistani students should follow the alternate guidelines outlined by their respective programmes for proof of residence.

Following is an example of the typical contents of a Residence Certificate. You can modify it based on the specific requirements of the programme you are applying for:

TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN

This is to certify that **[Full Name]**, son/daughter of **[Father's Name]**, born on **[Date of Birth]**, holding passport number **[Passport Number]**, currently resides at the following address:

[Complete Residential Address]
[City], [Province], [Country]

This certificate is issued upon the request of the named individual for the sole purpose of applying for further studies abroad.

Issued on: **[Date of Issuance]**
Place of Issue: [City, Province]

Authorized Signature
[Name of Official]
[Designation]
[Seal of the Municipality or Issuing Authority]

9 SCHOLARSHIP APPLICATION FORM

When applying for Erasmus Mundus, it is important to understand that the application process can vary between different programmes. Some programmes automatically consider all applicants for the Erasmus Mundus scholarship, meaning no separate application for the scholarship is required. In these cases, the general programme application serves as your scholarship application by default.

However, in other programmes, you may encounter separate forms for scholarship applicants and self-funded applicants. If you are seeking a scholarship, be sure to fill out the correct form and for the correct category (Programme Country vs. Partner Country). Failing to do so could disqualify you from scholarship consideration. Additionally, some programmes include a section in the main application form asking about your financial situation or explicitly whether you want to apply for the Erasmus Mundus scholarship. This helps the selection committee assess your eligibility for funding.

In certain cases, a programme may require a separate scholarship application form to be submitted alongside your main application documents. This form may request details about your financial status, background, or reasons for seeking the scholarship. Some programmes even ask for a separate motivation letter to justify why you should be considered for the scholarship.

As each Erasmus Mundus programme has its own unique process for applying, it is crucial to thoroughly review the programme's instructions. Check whether a separate scholarship form is needed and whether additional documents are required. Following the exact instructions will ensure your application is complete and that you are considered for both admission and the scholarship. Always leave plenty of time to gather the necessary materials and meet the deadlines for both the programme and scholarship applications.

10 EXPERIENCE CERTIFICATES

Experience certificates are not a standard requirement. Most programmes consider including your professional experience in your CV sufficient, and they may request additional proof only if necessary during the selection process. Therefore, it is generally not required to submit multiple certificates with your application unless explicitly stated by the programme.

However, if you want to showcase your work experience in more detail, there are a few ways to include these documents without overloading your application with unnecessary paperwork. One option is to upload your experience certificates to an online platform, such as Google Drive or Dropbox, and include links to these certificates in the relevant sections of your CV. This allows the selection committee to verify your experience without cluttering the application with too many documents.

Additionally, if the application form has a section for uploading additional documents, you can combine all your certificates into a single PDF file and submit them in that section. This approach ensures your documents are available if needed, without complicating the initial submission process.

11 PROGRAMME SPECIFIC DOCUMENTS

Some programmes may have additional or unique requirements based on their field of study or the programme's nature to assess your suitability more thoroughly. It is essential to carefully review these specific requirements for each programme you apply to. Here are some examples:

Portfolio Submission
In creative fields like design, architecture, or arts, you may need to submit a portfolio showcasing your work. This could include a video or visual samples, which will be used to evaluate your creativity and skills. Ensure that your portfolio aligns with the programme's guidelines, such as the required file format, size, and specific content they are looking for.

Additional Essay
Certain programmes, particularly in areas like environmental or social studies, may ask for an additional essay on a specific topic. This helps the admissions committee understand your motivations and interests in the subject more deeply.

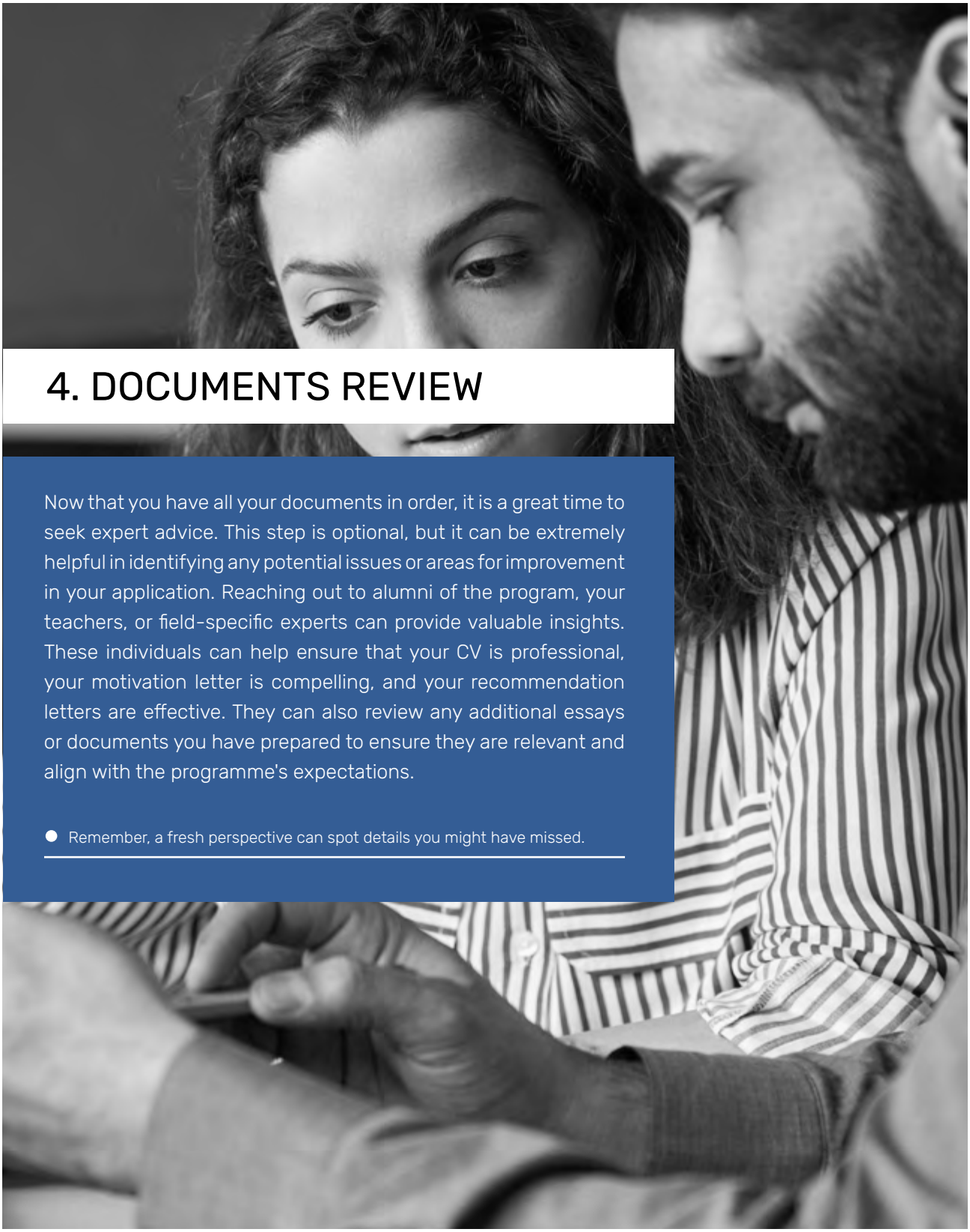
Specific Academic Requirements
Technical programmes may have specific prerequisites, such as required coursework in mathematics, computer science, or related sciences. Without these prerequisites, your application might not be considered, even if your overall academic record is strong. Some programmes may also request documents like a class ranking certificate or proof of your university's ranking.

12 OTHER SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS

Some programmes allow or encourage you to submit additional supporting documents. While this can be an opportunity to strengthen your application, it is important to be strategic about what you include. Only add documents that genuinely enhance your profile and support your candidacy for the programme.

Be cautious not to overload your application with unnecessary materials that might dilute its impact or potentially work against you. For example, GRE is not a requirement for any Erasmus Mundus programme. If you have taken the GRE and achieved a strong score, including the certificate could showcase your analytical and quantitative skills, adding value to your application. However, if your GRE score is not particularly impressive, it is advisable to omit it to prevent drawing attention away from your strengths.

Similarly, only include additional certificates, publications, or awards if they are relevant to the programme and highlight your qualifications. Irrelevant or marginally related documents can clutter your application and make it harder for the admissions committee to identify your most significant achievements.



4. DOCUMENTS REVIEW

Now that you have all your documents in order, it is a great time to seek expert advice. This step is optional, but it can be extremely helpful in identifying any potential issues or areas for improvement in your application. Reaching out to alumni of the program, your teachers, or field-specific experts can provide valuable insights. These individuals can help ensure that your CV is professional, your motivation letter is compelling, and your recommendation letters are effective. They can also review any additional essays or documents you have prepared to ensure they are relevant and align with the programme's expectations.

- Remember, a fresh perspective can spot details you might have missed.

THE IMPORTANCE OF EXPERT FEEDBACK

Seeking a review of your documents before submitting your Erasmus Mundus application is an optional but crucial step in refining your application. Alumni or experts who have already navigated the application process or who are familiar with the programme can provide valuable insights that can elevate your application beyond what you might achieve on your own.

Firstly, they can help identify blind spots or errors in your application that you may have missed after working on it for a long time. Having someone review your documents offers a fresh perspective, which can reveal inconsistencies, areas lacking clarity, or points that need further elaboration.

Secondly, their experience and insights into the selection process can help align your application with what selection committees are looking for. Alumni, for instance, have first-hand knowledge of what worked for them, and their feedback can ensure your CV, motivation letter, and other documents clearly communicate your strengths and fit for the programme. Their advice may help you refine your narrative to make it more compelling and focused on the programme's objectives.

Lastly, engaging with experts or alumni can ensure that your tone and style are professional and appropriate. They can help you make sure that your motivation letter is inspiring and effectively communicates your passion and future goals.

Having said that, it is important to remember that not every piece of advice you receive is necessarily right for you. While alumni and experts can offer valuable insights, it does not mean that their feedback will always be the best fit for your specific situation. Sometimes, your own understanding of your experiences, motivations, and goals might make you better equipped to craft your application than someone who has a different perspective.

Take their advice as constructive input, but ultimately, you are responsible for judging whether it aligns with your vision and how you want to present yourself. You can incorporate the feedback that resonates with you while trusting your instincts and knowledge to decide what works best for your application. This balance will allow you to create an application that is both polished and authentic.

RULES OF ENGAGEMENT WITH ALUMNI AND EXPERTS

When seeking advice from alumni or other experts during the application process, it is important to approach this step with care and respect. Before reaching out for assistance, make sure you have done your own research and completed your documents to the best of your ability. This shows that you value their time and are genuinely seeking constructive feedback, rather than expecting them to do the work for you.

Do Your Homework First:
Before reaching out, ensure that your application is complete and as polished as possible. This means thoroughly researching the programme requirements, writing your documents, and ensuring everything aligns with the guidelines. Alumni and experts are there to refine and guide you, not to complete the process for you. Approaching them with half-completed documents can be seen as disrespectful to their time and expertise.

Be Specific in Your Requests:
When asking for feedback, be clear about what kind of advice you need. Whether it is on the structure of your CV, the tone of your motivation letter, or how well your documents align with the programme's goals, targeted questions help alumni and experts provide more relevant and helpful feedback

Respect Their Time:
Keep in mind that alumni and professionals are often busy with their own careers and commitments. Be mindful of this and approach them with appreciation and respect for their time. If possible, give them ample time to review your documents and avoid rushing them with last-minute requests.

Follow Up Politely:
If you don't receive an immediate response, give it some time before following up. When you do follow up, be polite and express gratitude for their time and any feedback they can provide. This positive engagement can leave a lasting impression and build a valuable network for future opportunities.

UTILIZING SOCIAL MEDIA FORUMS

Social media platforms can be a valuable resource for applicants looking for guidance and support. Groups like **Erasmus Mundus Association - Pakistan** and **Scholarship Network Pakistan** on Facebook provide an excellent platform to connect with current students, alumni, and fellow applicants. These communities offer insights into the application process, tips on crafting a strong CV and motivation letter, and personal experiences from those who have already gone through the programme.

You can join the following Facebook groups for more information and guidance:



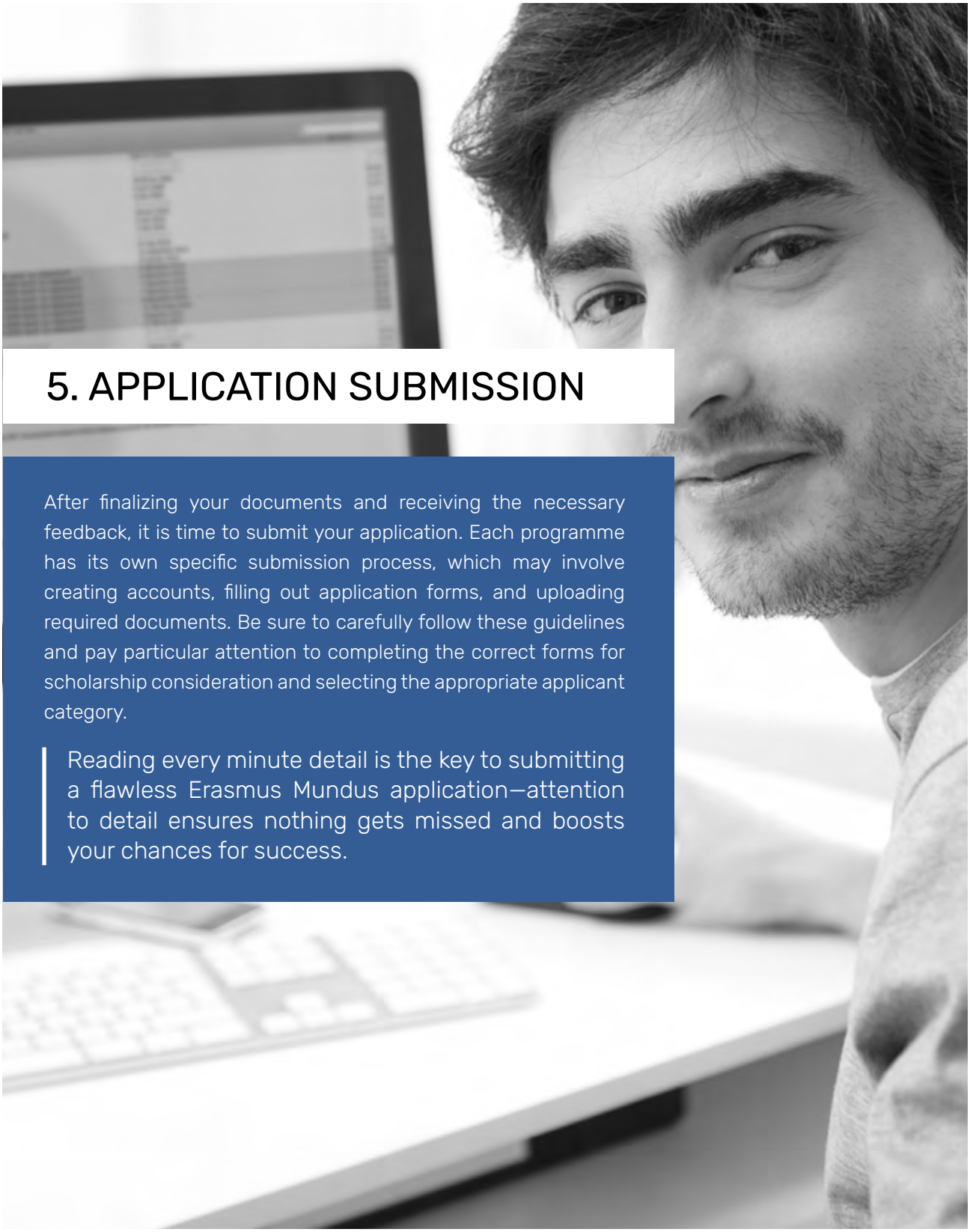
Erasmus Mundus Association
PAKISTAN
www.facebook.com/groups/EMAPakistan

Scholarship
Network
www.facebook.com/groups/scholarships.pk

STAY VIGILANT AGAINST SCAMMERS AND IMPOSTERS

Although, these forums can be helpful, it is important to remain vigilant against imposters or self-proclaimed experts who may not have your best interests at heart. Some individuals may pose as experienced alumni or experts with the intent to scam applicants or fish for personal documents like motivation letters. Be cautious about sharing your documents openly or trusting unsolicited offers for help. Avoid sending personal information or full copies of your documents to people you do not know well, and always cross-check the credentials of anyone offering advice or assistance. Stick to well-known and verified sources, and when in doubt, consult the group admins.

Additionally, Erasmus Mundus Association - Pakistan runs annual campaigns for document reviews, where alumni and current students offer feedback on your application documents. Keep an eye out for such announcements and actively participate in these official reviews to ensure you receive trusted, quality feedback. This also helps you avoid the risk of falling victim to scams from unverified individuals offering similar services.



5. APPLICATION SUBMISSION

After finalizing your documents and receiving the necessary feedback, it is time to submit your application. Each programme has its own specific submission process, which may involve creating accounts, filling out application forms, and uploading required documents. Be sure to carefully follow these guidelines and pay particular attention to completing the correct forms for scholarship consideration and selecting the appropriate applicant category.

> Reading every minute detail is the key to submitting a flawless Erasmus Mundus application—attention to detail ensures nothing gets missed and boosts your chances for success.

FOLLOW INSTRUCTIONS

Every Erasmus Mundus programme has its own website with a dedicated section for applications or a link to an external application portal. Since there is no centralized Erasmus Mundus portal used by all programmes, it is important to follow the specific application procedure for each programme.

Typically, the application process follows these steps:

Registration on the Platform:

The first step is to register on the platform specified by the programme. This could be a dedicated portal for the consortium or the application platform of the coordinating university. If the programme is using the university's general admission portal, you may need to select the appropriate course from the list. Make sure you choose the programme specifically designated for the Erasmus Mundus application, as some universities offer similar programmes with slightly different names. It is crucial to follow the instructions on the programme's website to ensure you are registering on the correct platform.

Filling Out the Application Forms:

Once registered, you will proceed to fill out the online application forms. Most programmes use a single form for both general applicants and Erasmus Mundus scholarship applicants. However, in some cases, separate links or forms are provided depending on your applicant category (e.g., Programme Country or Partner Country). Ensure you are selecting the correct form to avoid complications in the process.

Providing Personal and Academic Information:

Application forms are typically divided into sections. You will first fill in your personal and identity information, such as your name, nationality, and contact details. Then, you will be asked to provide details about your academic history, including your degrees, qualifications, language proficiency, and any relevant experiences. Some programmes may also include a section regarding financial information or scholarship options. Ensure this section is filled out correctly, and in case of confusion, seek advice from alumni or peers.

Uploading Documents:

Next, you will need to upload the required documents. The process can vary—some programmes have a single document upload section, while others require documents to be uploaded in different sections (e.g., uploading your passport in the personal information section and degree certificates in the academic section). Make sure to check the required format and ensure that the scanned copies are high-resolution, clear, and readable.

Submitting Reference Letters:

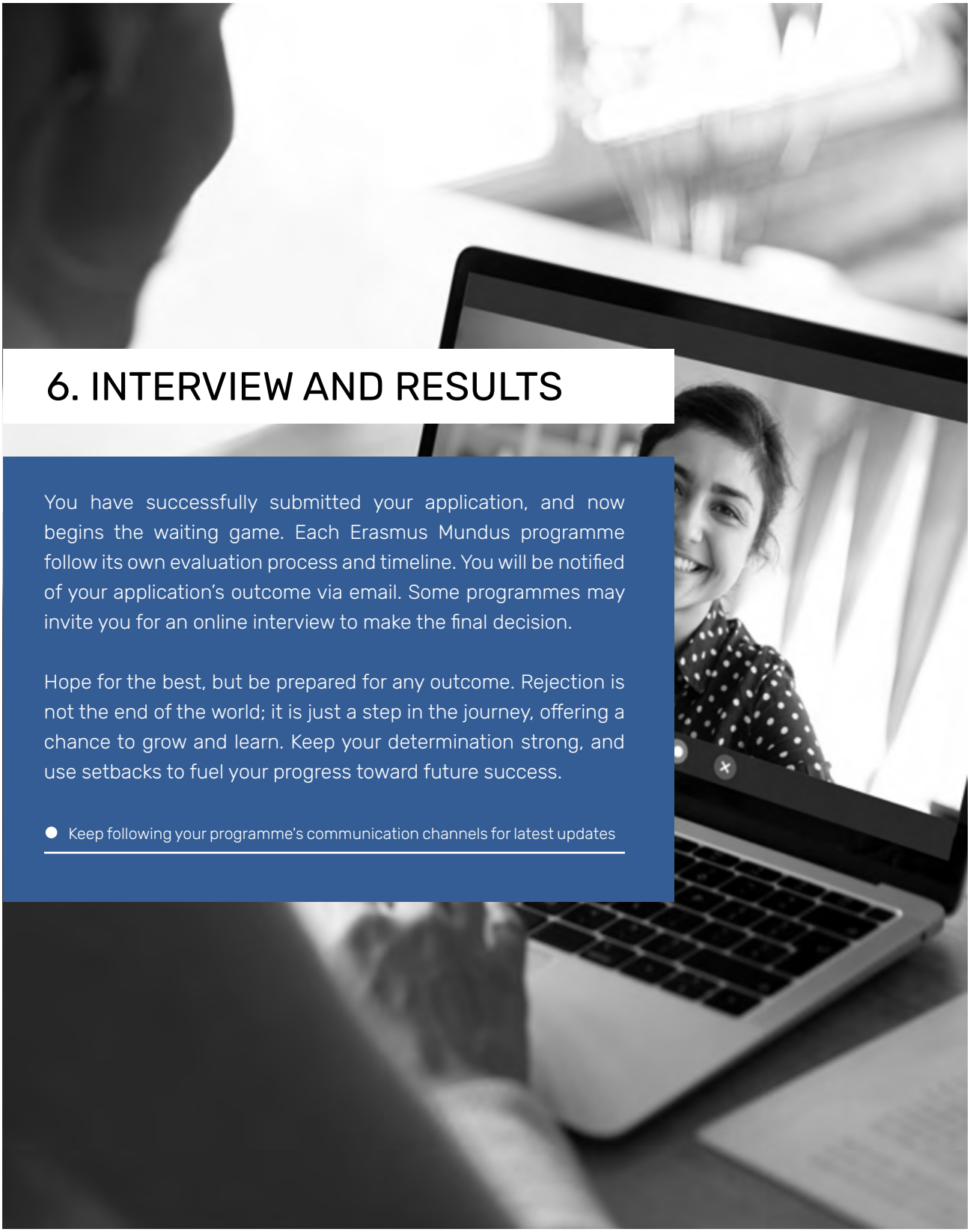
For reference letters, programmes may have different submission methods. Some programmes ask you to provide the referee's name and email, and the referee will then receive a link to upload the letter directly. In other cases, you may upload the reference letter yourself. Occasionally, programmes may require reference letters to be mailed to a specified address. Follow the programme's specific instructions to ensure the correct submission of these documents.

Final Submission:

Once you have completed all sections of the application and uploaded all necessary documents, you can submit your application. After submission, you may receive a confirmation email acknowledging receipt of your application. In some cases, you will also be able to monitor the status of your application directly through the portal.

It is essential to fill out all sections of the application form correctly and to ensure all documents are in the required format. If you have any doubts or need clarification on certain requirements, don't hesitate to seek guidance. Reaching out to the course coordinators can help clarify specific requirements, and sometimes, exceptions or alternative solutions may be available depending on individual circumstances.

A duly-filled and carefully prepared Erasmus Mundus application is crucial for success. Attention to detail ensures that each section is properly completed and that all necessary documents are submitted in the correct format. Even small errors can lead to delays or disqualification. A complete and error-free application not only demonstrates your professionalism but also reflects your commitment to the programme. Thoroughly reviewing each step, addressing any uncertainties, and double-checking everything before submission significantly increases your chances of success. Always seek guidance if you are unsure, ensuring that every detail aligns with the programme's specific requirements.



6. INTERVIEW AND RESULTS

You have successfully submitted your application, and now begins the waiting game. Each Erasmus Mundus programme follow its own evaluation process and timeline. You will be notified of your application's outcome via email. Some programmes may invite you for an online interview to make the final decision.

Hope for the best, but be prepared for any outcome. Rejection is not the end of the world; it is just a step in the journey, offering a chance to grow and learn. Keep your determination strong, and use setbacks to fuel your progress toward future success.

- Keep following your programme's communication channels for latest updates

POST-SUBMISSION

THE WAITING

After submitting your Erasmus Mundus application, all you can do is wait. It is important to note that there is no unified timeline or evaluation process for all Erasmus Mundus programmes, as each programme follows its own procedures. The evaluation can take anywhere from a few weeks to several months, depending on the programme and the number of applications. You will receive updates primarily via email, and it is crucial to regularly check your inbox for notifications. Be patient during this phase, and remember that timelines can vary greatly from one programme to another.

To stay informed, follow your programmes official channels and join social media groups like the Erasmus Mundus Association - Pakistan. Alumni, current students and applicants often share insights and timelines that can give you a better understanding of the process.

THE EVALUATION PROCESS

Each Erasmus Mundus programme evaluates applications based on specific criteria. Typically, these include academic achievements, professional experience, motivation, and alignment with the programme's objectives. The review process often starts with an eligibility check to ensure that basic requirements, such as academic qualifications and language proficiency, are met. Following this, your application will undergo a detailed assessment based on your submitted materials, including your CV, motivation letter, academic records, and recommendation letters.

Since no two programmes are the same, some may place more weight on professional experience, while others may focus on academic credentials or specific research interests. Therefore, it is essential that your application is tailored to the specific strengths and focus areas of the programme you are applying for.

INTERVIEW STAGE

For some programmes, the evaluation process may include an interview stage. Being invited for an interview is a positive sign that your application has stood out and shows the selection committee wants to further assess your suitability for the programme. The interview will allow them to evaluate your communication skills, verify the information in your application, and explore how well your profile aligns with the programme's objectives.

Here are some tips to remember:

1. Be Confident: Receiving an interview invitation is a clear indication that your application stood out and your academic and professional background has been recognized. Let this boost your confidence, knowing that you have already made a great impression through your application.

2. Contents of the Interview: There is no fixed format for Erasmus Mundus interviews, as each programme decides how to best assess and verify your profile. The questions typically revolve around your CV, motivation letter, and the details provided in your application. Be prepared for discussions on specific subjects relevant to the programme. Interviewers may focus on your academic experience, professional background, and overall knowledge in the field, ensuring that your qualifications align with the programme's goals and requirements.

3. Be Honest and Authentic: If you are asked about specific points on your CV or in your application, be prepared to discuss them in detail. If there is something you don't remember or are unsure about, it is better to admit it than to provide incorrect information. Integrity is crucial, as they want to ensure you were honest throughout your application process.

4. Brush Up on Field-Specific Knowledge: Be prepared to talk about your academic background, especially areas that are central to the programme. If you are applying for a technical program, you may be asked about tools or methodologies you have worked with. For scientific or analytical programmes, you might even be asked to solve problems or explain concepts.

5. Demonstrate Presentation Skills: Some programmes may require you to give a brief presentation, particularly if your thesis or project was a key part of your application. Keep your explanation concise—focus on the problem, methodology, and results. If applicable, use comparative graphs or figures, and avoid focusing too much on theory or unnecessary buzz words.

6. Ask Questions: At the end of the interview, you will often have the opportunity to ask questions. Take this chance to show your interest in the programme and clarify any lingering doubts. Thoughtful questions reflect enthusiasm and deeper engagement with the programme.

RESULTS AND NEXT STEPS

After all the evaluation phases are completed, you will be notified of the programme's decision. This process can take several weeks or even months. Once finalized, candidates will be informed of one of the following outcomes: **Accepted with Scholarship**, **Accepted without Scholarship (Self-Funding)**, or **Rejected**. In some cases, candidates may also be placed on a **Reserved List**, meaning they are accepted but without a scholarship, with the potential to be upgraded to scholarship status if spots become available.

1. Accepted with Scholarship
This is the most favourable outcome for any applicant. If accepted with a scholarship, you will receive a notification requesting you to confirm your participation in the programme. After confirming, you will be provided with detailed instructions on the next steps and the documents needed to start the visa processing. This outcome means your spot in the programme is fully secured and funded. In some cases, the scholarship offer may be conditional, requiring you to submit missing documents—such as proof of language proficiency or additional academic records—before final confirmation.

2. Accepted without Scholarship (Self-Funding)
In this scenario, you have been accepted into the program, but without a scholarship. While this may not be the outcome you were hoping for, it is still a significant achievement. Being selected out of hundreds of candidates means your profile stood out and was deemed strong enough for admission, which should boost your confidence. Erasmus Mundus programmes are highly competitive, with limited scholarships available, and the selection process follows strict guidelines to ensure global diversity. As a result, even top-ranked applicants might not receive scholarship—luck plays a crucial role—especially when it comes to regional quotas or scholarship allocations for specific nationalities.

If you are offered a place without a scholarship, you will need to bear the costs of tuition fees, living expenses, and other associated costs on your own. It is important to reach out to the programme coordinators to clarify the financial obligations and payment timelines. Additionally, inquire about alternative funding opportunities, such as university scholarships or tuition fee waivers, which might help alleviate some of the financial burden.

3. Rejection
Receiving a rejection can be disappointing, but it is essential to remember that not everything will always align with your expectations. Erasmus Mundus programmes follow strict selection criteria that account for academic merit, professional experience, and the relevance of your background to the programme. Many minor factors often influence the final decision, and even highly qualified candidates might not be selected due to reasons like a high volume of strong applicants. Rejections can also happen due to missing documents or unmet eligibility criteria, making it crucial to ensure your application is not only complete but also aligned with the programme's focus.

While rejection may feel like a setback, it is important to view it as part of the learning process and an opportunity to grow. Every rejection should motivate you to improve your profile, strengthen your qualifications, and prepare better for future applications. With this mindset, setbacks can serve as stepping stones toward your ultimate success.

WHEN AND HOW TO APPEAL

If you believe there has been a clear administrative error or oversight in the evaluation of your Erasmus Mundus application, you may be eligible to file an appeal. Erasmus Mundus programmes have a formal process for appeals, and you should carefully follow the instructions outlined on their respective websites.

It is important to understand that appeals must be grounded in factual errors, not personal opinions or a belief that you should have been selected. For instance, an appeal may be valid if your application was rejected due to not meeting the language requirements, even though you had submitted the necessary documentation to prove your proficiency. In such cases, appealing the decision would be appropriate. However, if your rejection is based on merit, such as having a lower score compared to other applicants, there is no ground for an appeal. In this case, it is essential to accept the decision and recognize that the selection process favoured higher-scoring candidates.

THE RESERVED LIST

If you are placed on the Reserved List, it indicates that your application is strong enough for acceptance but that a scholarship was not immediately awarded due to limited funding. However, there is still a possibility that scholarship spots may become available if other candidates decline their offers or fail to meet specific requirements. It is important to understand that this process is unpredictable, as moving up from the reserved list depends on how the situations of other candidates unfolds.

While you are on the reserved list, it is crucial to keep open lines of communication with programme coordinators to stay updated on your status and any changes in timelines. Additionally, it is a good idea to explore alternative funding sources, such as university scholarships, grants, or external financial aid options. This preparation ensures that you are ready for any scenario, whether a scholarship becomes available or you need to consider self-funding.

GOOD LUCK

As you embark on your Erasmus Mundus journey, remember that the biggest obstacle is often self-doubt. Don't let a lack of confidence or fear of failure hold you back from applying. Thousands of students from all backgrounds, with diverse academic profiles, have successfully navigated this process and found themselves on life-changing adventures in international education. There is no reason why you can't be one of them.

The application process may seem daunting, but it is an opportunity to showcase your passion, skills, and determination. Every step you take, whether successful or not, brings valuable experience and growth. Don't let the fear of rejection stop you from trying, because every great opportunity requires taking that first leap of faith.

On behalf of Erasmus Mundus Association - Pakistan, we encourage you to pursue your dreams fearlessly. Whether you secure a scholarship or not, the experience of applying, connecting with people, and growing your profile is invaluable. Believe in your potential and give it your best shot—you never know where it might lead you.

Good luck,

We hope to see you as part of the Erasmus Mundus family.

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